Rudder, when you get lots of users on a dating website, the natural tendency of men on the platform is to approach the most beautiful women. Scaling male behavior creates the problem that most of the men who approach a highly attractive woman will be markedly *less* attractive-she is "out of their league," as the saying goes. When these B-level males (our description, not Rudder's!) bombard the A-level females with requests for a date, no one is happy. The beautiful females are unhappy and likely to abandon the site because of all the unfiltered attention, while the B-level males are unhappy because the their choice never respond. And the few highly attractive men who might have been a good match for the most attractive women are unhappy because the women they want have left the platform.14

Once this happens, the men at all attractiveness levels converge on the women in the second most beautiful tier, and the whole pro- cess repeats. Network effects reverse, and the business model breaks down.

To solve this problem, OkCupid implemented a curation strategy involving multiple levels of network matching. The first level addresses the obvious issue of matching compatible interests. Do both parties smoke? Do both parties like tattoos and horror movies? Do both par- ties believe in dinosaurs? This level eliminates many clearly unsuit- able matches and reduces the number of participants in the process.

The second matching level addresses the question of compara- tive attractiveness-the "in her league" question. If OkCupid's algo- rithm determines, based on reactions by other users, that Joe is significantly less attractive than Mary (for example), then Joe's routine search for matches will not turn up Mary's picture. (She might show up in a highly targeted search, but not otherwise.) Instead, Joe will be presented with a selection of women thought to be comparable to him in attractiveness. The result is win-win. Mary is happier because the platform helps her find what she's looking for while protecting her from an onslaught. And Joe is happier, too, because women are returning his messages when previously he got the cold shoulder.

Of course, the use of this algorithm means that, if a guy only sees pictures of average-looking women when conducting an OkCupid search, he probably doesn't have the movie-star good